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Weplace App Enhancement and Commercialization Strategy Blueprint

Transforming neighborhoods into hyper-local infrastructure.

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Executive Summary & Strategic Vision

Problem

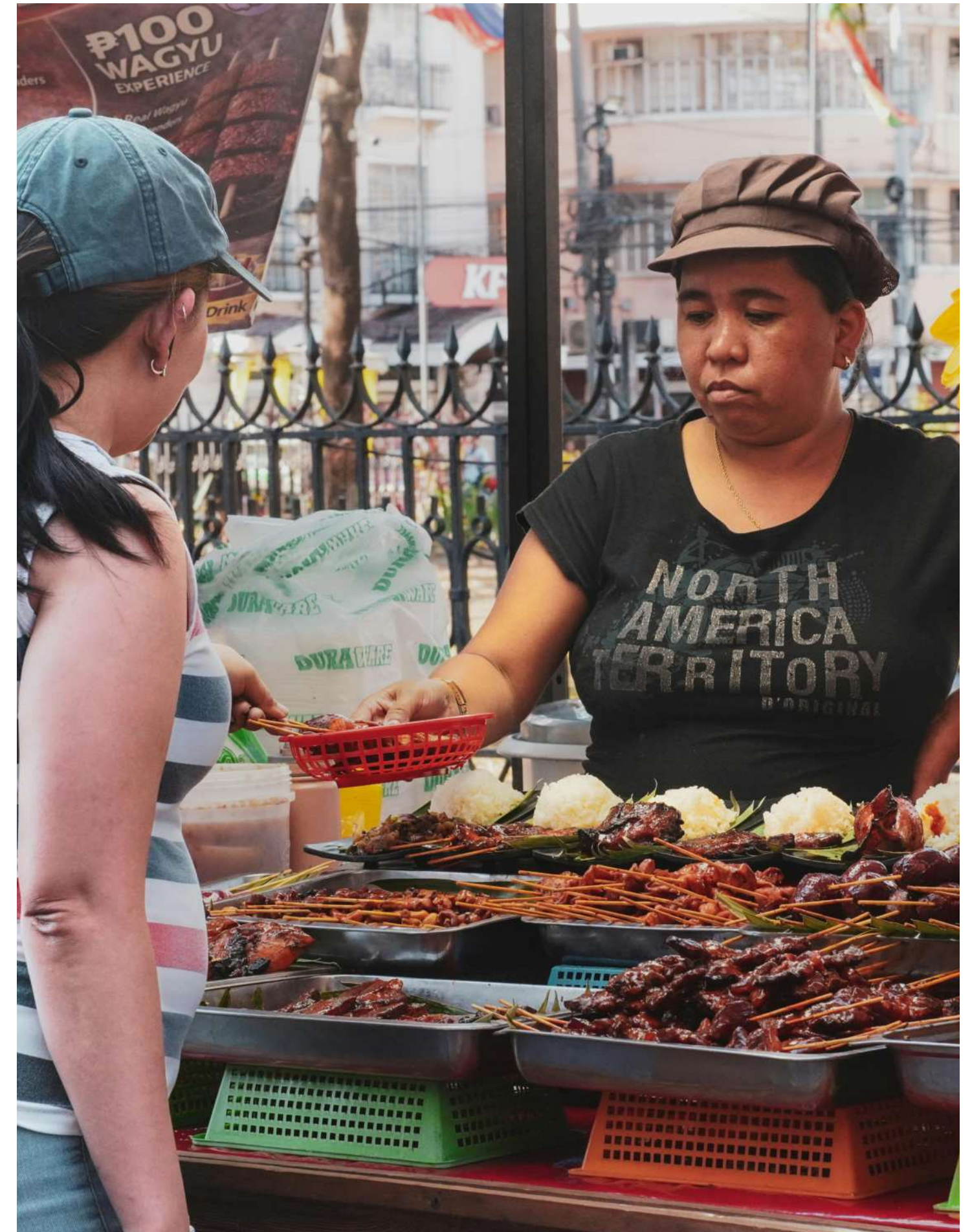
In the post-pandemic era, **household businesses and side hustles have seen rapid growth**; However, the **high commission rates** charged by major platforms (such as **Foodpanda and GrabFood**), coupled with the issues of **overwhelming content and lack of governance inherent** in traditional social media channels (such as **Facebook Groups and WhatsApp groups**), have **hindered the development of micro-merchants**. Community residents **lack efficient, secure channels for local transactions and mutual assistance**.

Vision

Transform the spirit of '**Kita Jaga Kita**' into a lower-barrier, high-user-retention, light-asset, **Hyperlocal Infrastructure platform**.

Mission

By building a '**trust infrastructure + regional hyper-local networks + SaaS-powered tools**', we aim to make Weplace the app of choice for neighbourhood commerce and services in Malaysia.



Strategic Positioning Matrix

Dimension	Traditional social media (FB Group/WhatsApp)	Major e-commerce/food delivery platforms (Shopee/Grab)	Weplace target positioning
Coverage radius	General community / No specific geographical boundaries	5 km – Nationwide	Precise 1 km – 2 km neighbourhood radius
Trust in Trade	No safeguards, private contact – highly susceptible to scams	The platform offers excellent protection , but charges high commission (15–30%)	Lightweight Guarantee (5% credit commission / 0% COD)
Entry barriers for merchants	Zero barrier to entry, but the feed is easily flooded with posts	Complex licensing requirements require professional operational expertise	Minimalist 'community micro-shops', with information retained long-term
Community characteristics	Pure information feed, lacking structured business operations	No community warmth ; purely a buyer-seller relationship	Structured pre-sale/direct sale + endorsement based on neighbourhood trust



4 Strategic Pillars



**Trust Infrastructure
& Data Security**



**Hyper-Local B2B
Merchant Acquisition**



**Pre-Order Group
Buying & B2B2C
Supply**

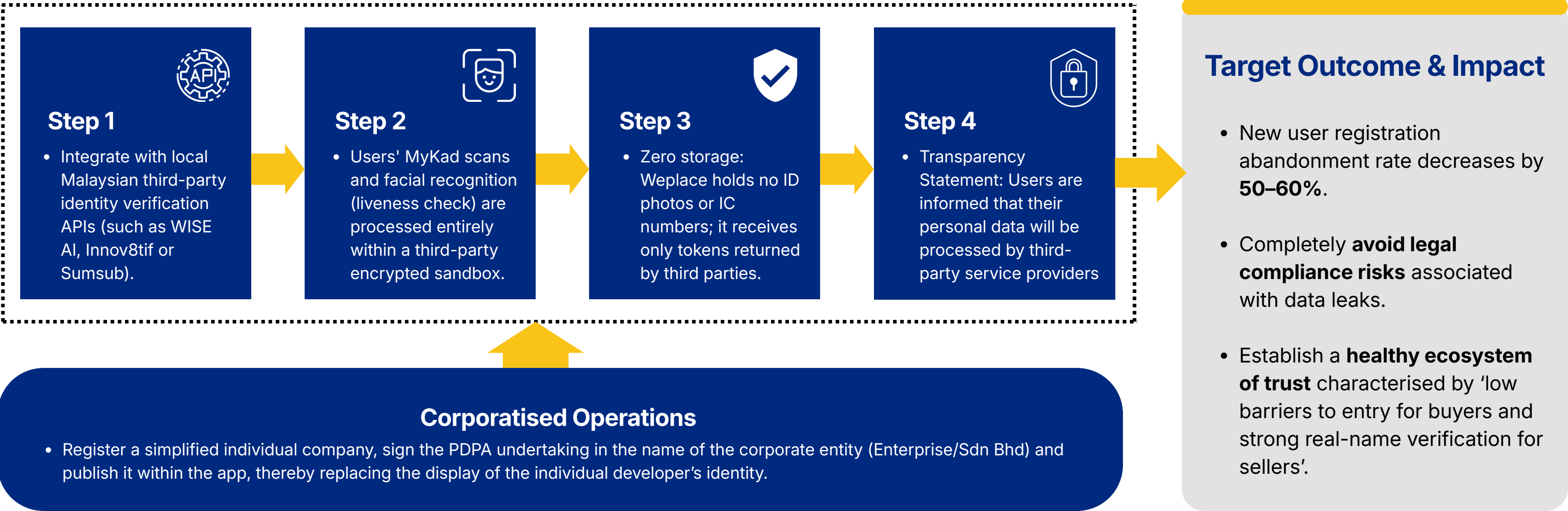


**SaaS Toolkit &
Subscription**

Pillar 1: Trust Infrastructure & Data Security

Objective: To establish a 'cornerstone of secure transactions' across the entire platform whilst **ensuring zero compliance risk**, thereby **resolving user's privacy concerns regarding the requirement to upload their MyKad**.

The Sandbox Mechanism



Pillar 2:

Hyper-Local B2B Merchant Acquisition

Step 1: Select the Pilot Zone

- Select **one or two densely populated residential areas** (such as Kepong, Puchong, Petaling Jaya etc) as targeted breakthrough zones, avoiding scattering resources across the country.

Step 2: Launch the 'First 100 Merchants Programme'

- Offering a '**permanently free basic version + an exclusive 1km community priority listing**', with **no upfront fixed fees**.

Step 3: Offline promotion & targeted outreach (FB/Xiaohongshu 'Relocation')

- Sales pitch focus: "Your posts on the Facebook group get buried within 10 minutes. At Weplace, we provide you free 'community micro-shops' where **residents within 2 km radius can find you at any time**; your **information is never lost**, and you can even **receive orders automatically**."

Target Outcome & Impact

- Secure **30-50 high-quality local businesses** within one month.
- Weplace platform fosters a supply ecosystem where residents can '**find things to buy or services to choose from nearby**', thereby encouraging them to **download and use the app**.

Objective:

To address the challenges of a small user base & low community engagement in the platform's early stage, this strategy **targets local SMEs**—businesses with **high transaction frequency, high customer retention, and an urgent need for local clients**—to achieve a 'cold start' on the supply side.

Target Merchant Profile:

Home-based Micro-Businesses

Homemade baked goods, chilli sauce, dumplings, sewing service.

Business problem: Unable to afford **high commission rates**, urgently seeking **customers within 1-2 km radius**.

Hyper-local Services

On-site air-conditioning repair and cleaning services, on-site pet grooming, domestic cleaning, and private tutoring.

Business problem: Heavy reliance on **local word-of-mouth**.

Taman small retail shops

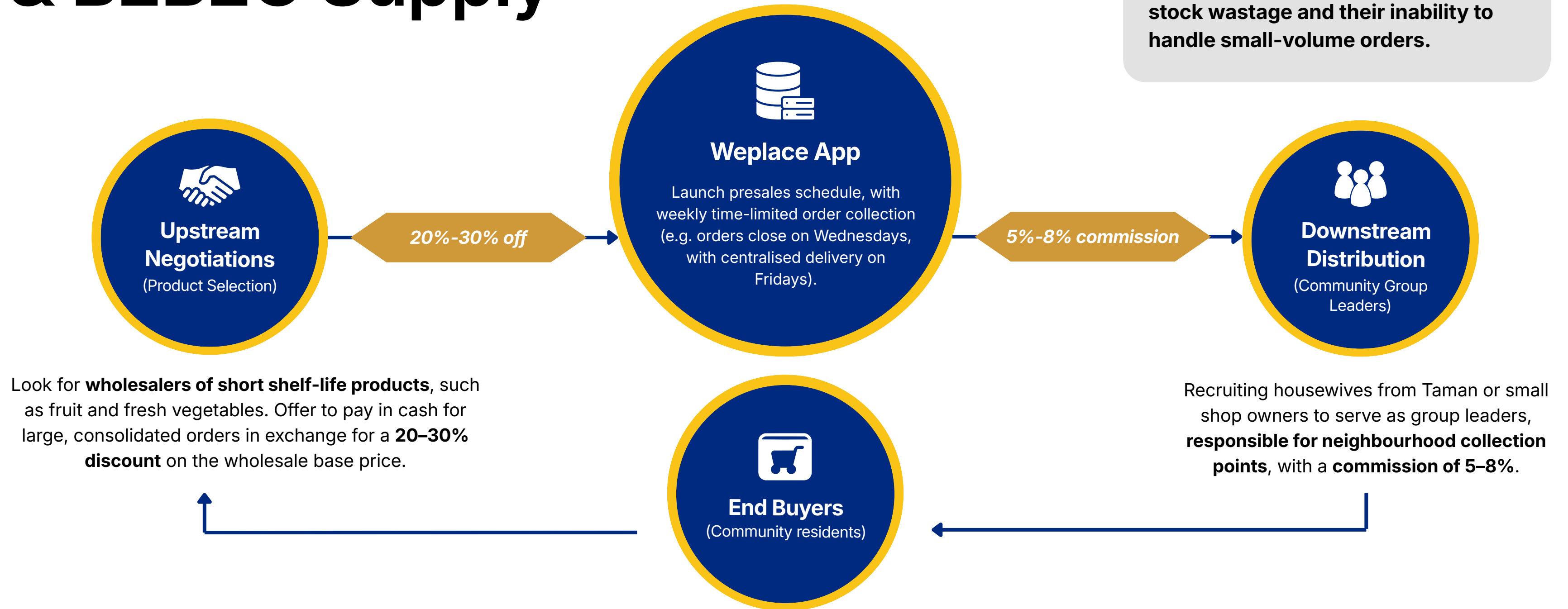
Neighbourhood car wash, independent hardware shop, independent café.

Business problem: **Competing with large chain stores**; urgent need to **boost visibility within the local community**

Pillar 3: Pre-Order Group Buying & B2B2C Supply

Objective:

Avoid heavy capital investment while lacking user traffic advantage. Target the challenge of **wholesalers' excess stock wastage and their inability to handle small-volume orders.**



Target Outcome & Impact: zero warehousing risk; a 30–40% increase in average order value; sustained profit from price differentials.

Pillar 4: SaaS Toolkit & Subscription

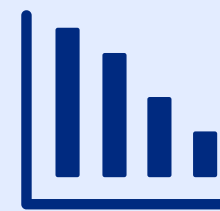
Objective: To **upgrade the existing basic subscription service** by adding the **SaaS Toolkit**, enabling merchants to 'understand their customers, save time and boost conversion rates', thereby **increasing the paid conversion rate on the merchant side**.

Before: Basic Subscription

- 5 Product Limit,
- 5 Market Listing Limit
- 2km radius
- Basic Order system
- 5% commission on transactions

After:

Add the SaaS Toolkit to expand value-added services



1. Data Analytics

- Community Heatmap (Which nearby street or block of flats generates the highest search volume for your product)
- Repeat Purchase Rate Statistics and Identification of High-Value Customers



2. Automated Marketing and CRM Toolkit

- One-click order export/formatted WhatsApp delivery lists
- Pre-sale/booking scheduling tool (automatic quantity limits, scheduled closing times)
- Automatic reminders for repeat purchases & customised voucher settings



3. Organic Priority & Badge

- Earn exclusive 'Local Verified Store' gold badge

Target Outcome & Impact

- Increase the merchant **subscription conversion rate** target to **8–12%**.
- Develop **stable monthly recurring revenue (MRR)** from SaaS, reducing reliance on a single revenue model based on transaction commissions.

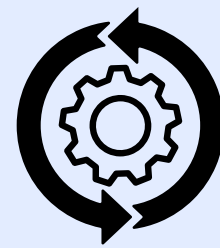
Monetization Architecture

Weplace Monetization Matrix



Transaction Commission Fee

- **5% commission fee** will be charged on each order settlement via the platform (excluding cash on delivery transactions).



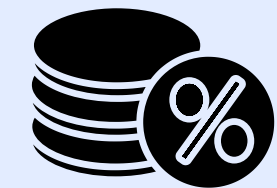
SaaS Merchant Subscription Fees

- **Pro Plan tiered pricing** (e.g. RM 29 per month or RM 299 per year), unlocking **CRM tools and data dashboards**.



Hyper-local B2B Ads

- **Featured businesses** within **2km** radius
- **Keyword recommendations** with extremely **low advertising costs**(e.g., RM 10/week).



Group-buying Commission

- Earn a supply chain **gross margin** of **10–15%** between the wholesale base price and the community retail price.



Roadmap & Implementation Milestones



Phase 1: Rebuilding Trust and Upgrading Infrastructure

- Integrate a third-party eKYC API and introduced tiered authentication
- Redesigned the Pro Plan SaaS features (order export, pre-sale scheduling)



Phase 2: Target Area Promotion and Seed Merchants

- Target 1 Pilot area for an offline, centralised business recruitment drive
- Prioritise securing contracts with over 30 small family-run businesses, service providers and independent shops



Phase 3: Pre-sale Centralised Procurement

- Establish partnerships with 2–3 local short-shelf-life products wholesalers
- Recruit 5 community leaders to launch limited-time pre-sales each week



Phase 4: Commercial Scaling and Model Replication

- Launch hyper-local advertising monetisation
- Replicate the successful SOP in 3 new neighbouring communities

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Conclusion

Weplace already has an excellent localised positioning ("Kita Jaga Kita"), as well as a robust framework for core operations and geofencing.

By **avoiding competition with site-based or locker-based business models** that require substantial capital investment, Weplace can focus its resources on **"alleviating data security concerns through eKYC"**, **"empowering upstream suppliers and group-buying organisers** through bulk purchasing via pre-sales", and **"upgrading merchant subscription services using SaaS tools"**. Through these initiatives, Weplace will successfully make a qualitative leap from an 'idealistic community platform' to a **'local lifestyle ecosystem with high commercial value'**.

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